



Mixed fortunes: Kimi Antonelli is now the first teenager to lead the championship standings since Lewis Hamilton in 2007 and the first Italian driver to win back-to-back races since Alberto Ascari in 1953. Facing page: Oliver Bearman's mangled car after the crash. AFP & GETTY IMAGES

looking to harvest energy into the battery by going slower, Bearman had unlocked more speed by deploying battery power. While taking evasive action, the Haas car ran through a brake marker board before sliding into the barriers along the wall. Bearman was seen limping back to the service road after the high-impact crash.

Williams driver and director of the Grand Prix Drivers' Association, Carlos Sainz, called it an accident waiting to happen, suggesting that F1 and the FIA had not heeded the drivers' safety concerns. "We've been warning them about this happening. I'm not very happy with what we've had up until now.

Hopefully, we come up with a better solution that doesn't create these massive closing speeds and [ensures] a safer way of going racing," the Spaniard told reporters after the race. "Here, we were lucky there was an escape road. Now imagine going to Baku or going to Singapore or going to Vegas and having this kind of closing speeds

and crashes next to the walls," he added.

The crash and the subsequent complaints from the drivers forced the FIA to put out a statement regarding prospective changes to the energy management system. "A number of meetings are scheduled in April to assess the operation of the new regulations and to determine whether any refinements are required. Any potential adjustments require careful simulation and detailed analysis. At this stage, any speculation regarding the nature of potential changes would be premature," the statement read.

With five weeks to go before the next Grand Prix in Miami, due to the cancellation of the races in Bahrain and Saudi Arabia, the FIA and F1 management will have to come up with a solution to tackle the issues of closing speeds, which are inherent in this generation of battery-powered racing. Safety should be priority number one, even if that entails taking a few steps back in the use of electrical energy.

MotoGP

Marco Bezzecchi extended his winning streak to five races after victory at the United States Grand Prix at the Circuit of the Americas (COTA). He led an Aprilia 1-2 with teammate Jorge Martin, who had won the sprint race on Saturday but started seventh on the grid, ahead of KTM's Pedro Acosta. Despite only starting on the second row, Bezzecchi (below) surged into second place before the first corner, then overtook leader Acosta after a slight argy-bargy, which resulted in his seat padding flying off the bike. When he crossed the start-finish straight at the end of lap one, he broke Jorge Lorenzo's record for the most consecutive MotoGP laps led. Pole-sitter Fabio Di Giannantonio finished fourth as the lead Ducati ahead of defending champion Marc Marquez, who responded after serving a long-lap penalty to round out the top five.

